

MT Malta (MT) — Regjistru tad-dokumenti / Document Registry

Sistema ta' edukazzjoni dwar is-saħħa / Health Education System: PSCD (Personal, Social and Career Development) — mandatory subject

Bioregion: Mediterranean

Reform Status: PSCD curriculum current; Malta unique for total abortion ban (2023 minor reform); conservative social context

Dan ir-regjistru jinkludi l-lista tad-dokumenti sors kollha identifikati għal Malta fil-proġett OneHealth EU.

This registry lists all source documents identified for Malta in the OneHealth EU project.

System Overview

Malta has a **centralised education system** managed by the **Ministry for Education, Sport, Youth, Research and Innovation (MEYR)**. Health education is delivered primarily through the subject **PSCD** — *Personal, Social and Career Development* — which is a mandatory subject in Maltese secondary schools (Forms 1–5, ages 11–16). PSCD is the primary vehicle for personal development, health, wellbeing, relationships, and sexuality education. Malta is notable as the **only EU country with a total ban on abortion** (though a minor medical exception was introduced in 2023), which strongly influences the parameters of sexuality education. The **Malta Health Network** and **Health Promotion Directorate** support school health initiatives.

A. Qafas legali / Legal Framework

1. Education Act (Cap. 327) — Att dwar l-Edukazzjoni

- **Type:** Act of Parliament | **Year:** 1988 (as amended)
- **Publisher:** Parliament ta' Malta
- **Description:** The foundational Maltese education law. Provides legal basis for the curriculum framework, mandatory subjects including PSCD, and the role of the state in education. Incorporates provisions for religious values in a predominantly Catholic context.
- **Access (legislation.mt):** <https://legislation.mt/eli/cap/327>

2. PSCD Curriculum Framework and Syllabus — *Personal, Social and Career Development*

- **Type:** Subject curriculum | **Year:** Current
- **Publisher:** Ministry for Education, Sport, Youth, Research and Innovation (MEYR) / Directorate for Quality and Standards in Education (DQSE)

- **Description:** The official curriculum framework for PSCD in Maltese schools (Forms 1–5). Content includes: personal development, health and wellbeing, relationships, sexuality (within the constraints of Maltese law and Catholic social teaching), career education, and citizenship. PSCD is one of the more comprehensive personal development subjects in a Mediterranean EU country.
- **Access (curriculum.gov.mt):** <https://curriculum.gov.mt/en/Subjects/Personal-Social-and-Career-Development/Pages/default.aspx>

3. Abortion Amendment — Att dwar it-Terminazzjoni tat-Tqala 2023 (context document)

- **Type:** Act of Parliament (amendment) | **Year:** 2023
- **Publisher:** Parlament ta' Malta
- **Description:** Malta introduced a limited exception to its total abortion ban in 2023, allowing termination only in cases of immediate risk to the mother's life. Context document for understanding the legal and sociocultural constraints on sexuality education content in Malta — notably, PSCD content on reproductive rights must operate within this restrictive framework.
- **Access (legislation.mt):** <https://legislation.mt>
- **Health Promotion Directorate:** <https://health.gov.mt>

B. Dejta dwar is-saħħa / Health Data

4. HBSC Malta 2022 — Health Behaviour in School-aged Children

- **Type:** Research report | **Year:** 2022 | **Publisher:** University of Malta / WHO
- **Description:** Malta's contribution to the international HBSC study. Data on health behaviours, wellbeing, substance use, and sexual health of Maltese adolescents. Notable for data on the unique sociocultural context of health behaviour in a small island state with a strong Catholic tradition.
- **Access (University of Malta):** <https://www.um.edu.mt/healthsciences/hbsc/>

C. Analytical Files in Project Repository (NotebookLM)

File	Contents
MT_EN_Ramy_Prawne_PSCD_Aborcja2023_2025.md	Legal framework — Education Act, PSCD, abortion law 2023, religious context
MT_EN_Curriculum_HBSC2022_OneHealth_FAQ_27Krajow.md	Curriculum content in PSCD, HBSC data, One Health context, FAQ comparing 27 countries

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